

What is Popular is Not Always Right.

Maeve: Hey, Sophia, my friends and I are going roller skating after school today. Do you want to come?

Sophia: I would love too. It might be a little awkward though. I don't know your friends that well.

Maeve: You'll be fine.

Sophia: Uh, O.K. What time are we going?

Maeve: Five till eleven.

Sophia: Six hours! Do we really need that long?

Maeve: We won't just be roller skating. We have some other games planned.

Sophia: And do you think it's a good idea to be out that late at night?

Maeve: (pause) I think it's a fun idea.

Sophia: Um... I'll have to ask mum.

Maeve: Uh-uh. Bad idea.

Sophia: Why?

Maeve: None of the other parents know about it. I don't want them to think I'm weird because I'm friends with a goody two shoes.

Sophia: Excuse me?

Maeve: Look Sophia, these aren't your always supportive, always good, never-let-you-down Christian friends. If you aren't cool, if you don't fit in, they will most likely ditch you.

Sophia: They don't sound like very nice people to me. Let alone friends.

Maeve: You're missing the point. Sophia please. This means so much to me.

Sophia: But why? Why do you want to be friends with these people?

Maeve: Because all my life I have been trying to fit in somewhere, to belong. Now I have that and I don't want to lose it.

Sophia: Great, now you're guilt tripping me.

Maeve: It won't be the same without you.

Sophia: I can't come anyway Maeve. I have homework. And you do too.

Maeve: Oh, homework can wait. We'll do it later.

Sophia: Like when?

Maeve: Over the weekend. We have tons of time.

Sophia: I guess so, but...

Maeve: See you there!

Sophia: Wait, what? Maeve, wait up! I have to babysit Alisa this evening.

Maeve: Nice try. Stop making excuses.

Sophia: No, I'm serious. I just remembered.

Maeve: (groans loudly) Isn't she nine?!

Sophia: Um...yeah.

Maeve: She's old enough to look after herself! And what's the worst that can happen?
The house burning down?

Sophia: That would be really bad. (gasps) I think I left the matches on the kitchen bench! What if she grabs them?!

Maeve: She's not going to touch the matches.

Sophia: She might.

Maeve: Stop thinking so hard. Everyone has snuck away from their parents to have fun before.

Sophia: That is so wrong.

Maeve: I should not have said that.

Sophia: I am not just going to throw away all the trust they have put in me for six hours of fun.

Maeve: No, you're right. Six hours isn't worth it.

Sophia: There. I knew you would see it my way.

Maeve: We should make it 12.

Sophia: Why do I bother?

Maeve: I don't know. Come on.

Sophia: Why can't we just like...make it from 3:30 to 7:30 or something and ask permission?

Maeve: Um...maybe because that's not cool.

Sophia: Does it have to be cool?

Maeve: Yes, it does. Now come on.

Sophia: It really doesn't.

Maeve: (pause) It really does.

Sophia: It really doesn't.

Maeve: It does.

Sophia: It doesn't.

Maeve: Does.

Sophia: Doesn't.

Maeve: Does.

Sophia: Doesn't.

Maeve: Stop. We're done. Now let's go.

Sophia: You might be done, but I'm not.

Maeve: Too bad. I'm done, so you're done. Let's go!

Sophia: NO! I'm. Not. Going!

Maeve: Yes. You. Are!

Sophia: I'm not. You can't make me.

Maeve: (furious) Do you really want to let down your best friend?! Do you really want to be the only one not going?! Do you really want to live a boring, protected life?! Your parents don't expect you to be good all the time!

Sophia: They expect me to try.

Maeve: Your parents are harsh!

Sophia: Maybe they are. But they aren't trying to make my life miserable. They are trying to protect me.

Maeve: Oh yeah? Well, I don't need protecting! I am fully capable of looking after myself!

Sophia: So they all say.

Maeve: Stop trying to be my mother! You are always telling me what I should be doing! You are always telling me not to do something! Just leave me alone!

Sophia: (pause) I'm sorry. I don't mean to be always on your case.

Maeve snorts.

Sophia: You're right. I can't control the world. I can't control anyone. If you want to go, go.

Maeve: (shaking her head) I won't go without you. I'm sorry for getting mad. I would rather have you as my friend than them.

Sophia: We can hang out at my house tonight if you like.

Maeve: After homework and babysitting?

Sophia: After homework and babysitting.

Maeve: Why don't I just come over tomorrow? It might be simpler.

Sophia: (laughing) O.K.

Maeve: I'll bring lollies.

Sophia: We should make pizza.

Maeve: I'll have to go and tell the others I'm not going.

Sophia: Yeah. I can come if you like.

Maeve: Nah, it's O.K.

Sophia: (pause) What are you going to tell them?

Maeve: I can just say that I'm too busy or something.

Sophia: Or you can tell them the truth.

Maeve: Please tell me you're joking.

Sophia just looks at her.

Maeve: Okay, fine. What should I say?

Sophia: You should say, "I don't think it's a good idea to be out late at night without my parents knowing."

Maeve: Can I leave out the, "Without my parents knowing" part?

Sophia: Nope.

Maeve: Please?

Sophia: That's, like, the main reason we aren't going.

Maeve: (desperate) They don't have to know that!

Sophia: Maeve.

Maeve: Well, at least come with me.

Sophia: (rolls her eyes) I did offer.

Maeve: Good. Let's go.

By Grace and Holly Cullen